Pulse — User Stories, Personas & Scenarios

1. Introduction

This document captures the user research artefacts that shaped Pulse's feature set. It covers four personas across the primary target audiences (uni students, first-time parents, 9–5 workers, and feature-specific users), fifty-plus user stories grouped by audience, and eleven end-to-end scenarios that trace how each user journey plays out in the app.
Together these three artefacts form the "why" behind every feature: personas describe who we built for, stories describe what each user wants and why, and scenarios describe how the finished product delivers it.

2. User Personas

2.1 Emily — University Student

- **Age:** 20
- **Occupation:** First-year university student
- **Background:** Recently moved away from home. Adjusting to independent living while juggling study, finances, health, friendships and personal responsibilities. Uses mobile apps regularly to organise her day.
- **Goals:** Maintain balance across study, health, finances, relationships and wellbeing; build sustainable routines; notice which areas of her life need more attention; stay organised without adding complexity.
- **Pain points:** Feels overwhelmed by competing responsibilities. Finds it difficult to maintain routines during busy study periods. Doesn't want to spend time manually tracking her life. Prefers apps that are simple and intuitive.
- **Technology behaviour:** On her phone frequently. Comfortable with mobile apps but expects them to be intuitive. Prefers short, visual guidance over long instructions.

2.2 Priya Raman — Social Sharer

- **Age:** 24
- **Occupation:** Early-career physiotherapist, Melbourne
- **Background:** Has three friends on Pulse and treats the feed as light accountability. Joined a gym in February and stayed with it because a group chat noticed when she stopped going — Pulse works the same way for her.
- **Goals:** Keep a streak going and have someone notice; celebrate moments that took real effort (saving goal, a full day of missions); not have to remember to share — the app should catch the moment.
- **Pain points:** Finishing something that felt like an achievement and having the app say nothing. Hunting through menus to share. Posts that look like spreadsheet screenshots.
- **Behaviours:** Shares roughly weekly. Edits the pre-filled text about half the time. Notices

when a card looks designed rather than generated.
- **What she needs:** Prompts at the moment of completion. A card worth posting. Pre-filled text she can adjust.

2.3 Tom Whitfield — Private Tracker

- **Age:** 31
- **Occupation:** Operations coordinator, Perth
- **Background:** Has connected no friends on Pulse and does not intend to. Tracks his spending and to-dos, checks his scores on Sunday nights, and regards the social tab as clutter he tolerates.
- **Goals:** Track his own things, privately, with as little ceremony as possible. Never be interrupted mid-task.
- **Pain points:** Modals that appear between him and his task. Being asked the same thing twice. Features that assume everyone wants to be social.
- **Behaviours:** Dismisses prompts without reading. If prompted twice for the same thing, starts dismissing everything reflexively — including things he would have wanted. Would uninstall over persistent nagging before complaining.
- **What he needs:** Prompts on genuine achievements only. Never the same achievement twice. One-tap dismissal that is final.

2.4 Aisha Bello — Privacy-Conscious Sharer

- **Age:** 27
- **Occupation:** Postgraduate student, Brisbane
- **Background:** Shares occasionally and thinks about it afterwards. Once posted a budgeting screenshot to a group chat and spent the evening wishing she hadn't — the figures said more than she meant. Now reads what's on a card before posting.
- **Goals:** Share the fact of an achievement without the underlying detail. Stay in control of what the card says.
- **Pain points:** Cards that print exact amounts. Not being able to see what will be posted. Sharing something framed as a win that reads as a complaint or boast.
- **Behaviours:** Reads the card preview before pressing post. Abandons a share if the card says more than she intended. More comfortable sharing effort ("21 days") than outcome ("$280 of $300").
- **What she needs:** Percentages and counts rather than dollar figures. A preview that is exactly what gets posted. Cards that describe what she did rather than her circumstances.

2.5 Mia Tran — Privacy-Sensitive User

- **Age:** 22
- **Occupation:** Penultimate-year student, works part-time in retail, Canberra
- **Background:** Has four wellbeing apps on her phone and actively uses one. Joined Pulse because a friend from her course is on it and the five-domain idea matches how she thinks about her week. Logs a mood most days, journals a few times a week, has one saving plan running.
- **Goals:** Keep a private record of how she is actually going. See progress across the five areas without much admin. Share the occasional win with the two friends she's connected with. Know which parts are private.

- **Pain points:** Terms and conditions written to be agreed to rather than read. Not knowing whether something she typed is visible to anyone else. A fitness app that once posted to a feed she didn't know existed.
- **Behaviours:** Skims. Will read a short paragraph; will not read a page. Journals things she wouldn't say out loud, including on bad days. Feels the difference between a mood entry and a step count.
- **What she needs from consent:** Short version first, detail available if she wants it. Health and spirituality named plainly. An unambiguous statement of what is private by default. A way out that isn't buried.

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3. User Stories

3.1 Uni Student

- As a uni student, I want to be able to login, so I can save my progress. **(MVP)**
- As a uni student, I want a budget tracker, so I can track my expenses. **(MVP)**
- As a uni student, I want weekly missions, so I have more guidance on what to do.
- As a uni student, I want a study tracker, so I can record my study sessions.
- As a uni student, I want to track my engagement with friends, so I can maintain my relationships.
- As a uni student, I want a streak, so I can feel motivated to keep going.
- As a uni student, I want the app to prompt me to catch up with friends.
- As a uni student, I want a social feature in the app, so I can see how my friends are going.
- As a uni student, I want a to-do list, so I can track my daily tasks, assessments and interviews.
- As a uni student, I want a mood tracker and journal, so I can write down my feelings.
- As a student living away from home, I want to track patterns in my moods so I can identify triggers like stress, loneliness or homesickness.
- As a user, I want to edit or delete previous journal entries so I can correct mistakes.
- As a university student, I want the mood tracker to be simple and accessible so I can use it even during busy periods.
- As a student, I want to view mood history in graphs or calendars so I can visualise changes over time.
- As a uni student, I want to share progress from tasks I complete, so I can show friends and family.
- As a uni student, I want a saving-plan feature so I can create savings goals and track progress.
- As a first-time user, I want a short introduction to Pulse so I can quickly understand the purpose of the app.
- As a user, I want a privacy consent notice to appear so I can be informed of what data is collected.

3.2 First-Time Parent

- As a first-time mum, I want an entry quiz, so I can gauge where I am. **(MVP)**
- As a first-time mum, I want a physical activity tracker, so I can be more active. **(MVP)**
- As a first-time mum, I want a history log, so I can review and see my progress.
- As a first-time mum, I want a journal feature, so I can record my feelings and goals.

(MVP)
- As a first-time mum, I want a mood tracker, so I can see how I felt over the year. **(MVP)**
- As a first-time mum, I want a chore/todo list, so I can keep track of my daily and weekly tasks. **(MVP)**

3.3 9–5 Worker

- As a 9-5 worker, I want to receive prompts, so I can reflect about my life.
- As a 9-5 worker, I want a balance wheel/visual, so I can understand the status of each area. **(MVP)**
- As a 9-5 worker, I want the app to give me suggestions, so I can perform actionable steps to improve my life.
- As a 9-5 worker, I want the ability to take pictures of my new found hobbies.
- As a 9-5 worker, I want the app to inform me of my sleeping habits.
- As a 9-5 worker, I want a diet and calorie tracker, so I can see when I am eating healthy.
- As a 9-5 worker, I want each of the 5 domains to have a score so I can track my individual progress. **(MVP)**
- As a 9-5 worker, I want there to be a balance score, so I can see how balanced my life is. **(MVP)**
- As a 9-5 worker, I want a simplistic UI, so that it is easy to navigate. **(MVP)**
- As a 9-5 worker, I want a personalised daily balance plan based on my weak domains, so I can take simple actions each day. **(MVP)**

3.4 Social Feature Stories

- As a user, I want to add friends by email, so I can connect with people I know.
- As a user, I want to post a daily check-in, so I can share what I did to improve myself today.
- As a user, I want to view my friends' check-ins in a feed, so I can see their progress and feel encouraged.
- As a user, I want to like and comment on my friends' posts, so I can support them and interact socially.
- As a user, I want to message my friends, so I can communicate with them directly inside the app.
- As a user, I want the social feature to be simple and private, so I feel comfortable sharing without pressure.

3.5 Budget Tracker Stories (Low-Income Student)

- As a uni student on a low budget, I want to set a monthly cap per category so I can divide my payment across the pay period.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want to see my daily spending allowance so I know how much I can afford today without going broke before payday.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want a calendar that colours each day green or red so I can spot patterns like overspending every Friday night.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want to log an expense in under five seconds so tracking doesn't eat into my study time.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want to choose which account each expense came from so my savings and cash stay separated.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want a visual breakdown of where my money's going

so I can see whether food or socialising is the bigger drain.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want each category to show how close I am to its cap so I can ease off before I overshoot.
- As a uni student on a low budget, I want to delete an expense I logged by mistake so my totals stay accurate.

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4. Scenarios

4.1 Uni Student — John

John is a first-year interstate uni student. Newly moved in and never been out of home, he feels stressed, lonely and isolated. He downloads Pulse for more structure, likes the budget goals, friendship missions and study tracker, and builds a routine that makes him feel more comfortable.

4.2 First-time Mum — Maria

Maria is a first-time mum of a 2-year-old, Dave. She feels like she only focuses on family and has lost herself; she wants to reclaim her life: friends, fitness, work. She tracks going out with friends and gym sessions, journals her feelings and career goals, and feels more in control because she can visualise the changes she's making.

4.3 Burnt-out 9–5 Worker — Alex

Alex is a 9-5 worker in IT who feels drained from a monotonous routine. He has free time and money but no passions. The app identifies he needs to focus on spirituality. Through journal prompts about "interests", he rekindles old hobbies. The app encourages him to try them.

4.4 Task Management — Milena

Milena is a uni student with a part-time job. She uses the to-do list to add "Finish Week 5 Quiz" with a description, due date 04/05/2026 and medium priority. She reviews pending tasks, pays rent and ticks it off, deletes the cancelled "Attend the interview" task, and updates the due date for "Final Exam – ENGN8100" when the exam schedule changes.

4.5 Budget Tracker — Bartholomew

Bartholomew is a second-year student on Youth Allowance with no part-time job. Rent eats most of his fortnightly payment. He downloads Pulse because he keeps running out of money two days before payday. He sets category caps, glances at his daily allowance before deciding whether to grab lunch on campus, and watches the calendar turn green or red so he can course-correct mid-fortnight.

4.6 Mood Tracker — Ben

Ben is a 19-year-old first-year uni student who recently moved cities. He feels stressed, lonely or anxious without understanding why. Each evening he logs his mood by selecting an emotion, picking supporting feelings, and writing a short reflection. Over time Pulse displays patterns —

homesickness on weekends, stress before deadlines — and the saved journal entries let him look back on how he was feeling.

4.7 Daily Mission — James

James is a 9–5 worker feeling overwhelmed and disconnected. Pulse analyses his domain scores — Health and Financial are lowest — and generates a Daily Balance Plan with three actions: *Drink more water today*, *Avoid unnecessary spending today*, *Complete your most important task first*. He ticks each off during the day, finishing on 3/3.

4.8 Physical Activity Tracker — Chloe

Chloe is a first-time mum who has lost motivation to exercise. In the app she sees options for cardio and strength. She logs afternoon walks and watches her history grow; later she starts gym workouts, using custom exercises because she's a beginner. The tracker becomes stress relief from newborn life.

4.9 Social — Wolfgang

Wolfgang is a uni student who loses motivation working alone. He adds friends by email, views their daily check-ins, posts his own reflection with an optional photo, and swaps likes, comments and messages with them. The social loop keeps him accountable.

4.10 Saving Plan — Rihi

Rihi is a first-year uni student. She wants to buy an espresso machine, so she creates a Saving Plan titled "Coffee Machine" with a $400 target and $40 - day deadline. Pulse displays the daily required savings (10/day). After payday she deposits $120; the app recalculates to show $280 remaining, 30% complete, with an updated daily target.

4.11 Tutorial — Emily

Emily downloads Pulse to balance uni life. On the Home page she receives a short contextual tutorial explaining the five domain scores and the Diagram/Details toggle. As she visits each feature for the first time, short tutorials explain its key functions. Weeks later she can't remember how saving records work, so she opens *Profile → Help & Tutorials* and replays the Saving Plans walkthrough.
